

# Welcome

Thank you for purchasing CyberLink PowerDirector 2024. This Quick Start Guide contains all the information you need to get your new software up and running on your computer, and provides an overview of some of its features.

**Note:** you can access the full help file anywhere in the PowerDirector program by pressing the F1 key on your keyboard.

## Installation

To install PowerDirector, find the two discs that came in the retail box.

**Note:** if you don't have a working disc drive installed in your computer, you can download a digital copy of the program in the **CyberLink Member Zone**. To get your digital copy, go to the following URL and follow the instructions:

<https://membership.cyberlink.com/account/redeem>

## Before Installing

Before you install PowerDirector, here are some recommendations to ensure the installation goes smoothly.

- Close all other applications, including anti-virus software.
- If you previously installed a trial version of PowerDirector, it is recommended that you uninstall it before proceeding.
- Make sure your computer meets PowerDirector's minimum system requirements (see the box or our product page on the Internet).
- Ensure all your computer's drivers are up-to-date, including firmware for your disc drive and any other hardware.
- Find your product key and have it ready. You can find it on the disc envelope, or on a sheet that was included in the box.

## Installing PowerDirector

To install PowerDirector on your computer, do this:

1. Find the disc that came in the box labeled **Disc 1 Software**, take it out of the disc envelope, and then insert it into your disc drive. The disc will autorun and open the installation wizard.

**Note:** if the disc does not autorun, open Windows File Explorer, double click on your disc drive, and then on the Launch.exe file.

2. Click on the **Install** button.
3. Select the language of the installation and then click **OK**.

**Note:** you can always change the UI language later in General settings.

4. Review the terms of the end user licensing agreement (EULA), which grants you a license to use the software. If you accept the agreement, click **Yes** and proceed to the next window. If you do not accept, the installation process will not continue, as you cannot install the software unless you accept the agreement.
5. Enter the product key in the field provided and then click **Next**.

6. If required, select the location where the programs will be installed. To install to the current folder, click **Next**. To install to a different folder, click **Browse**, select another folder, and then click **Next**.
7. In the next window you can select which software programs will be installed, and whether you want to install any of the extra content. Make your selections and then click **Next** to continue.
8. Setup will start the installation process. Once the installation is complete, click **Finish**.

## Installing Extra Content

On both of the discs you received in the box, there is extra content you can choose to install. Install this extra content to ensure you have all the premium effects and templates you need to create your video productions in PowerDirector. The extra content includes:

| Extra Content               | Location             |
|-----------------------------|----------------------|
| Content Pack Premium 1      | Disc 1 Software      |
| Content Pack Premium 2      | Disc 1 Software      |
| Content Pack Premium 3      | Disc 1 Software      |
| Content Pack Premium 4      | Disc 1 Software      |
| Content Pack Premium 5      | Disc 1 Software      |
| Wedding Pack Vol. 2*        | Disc 1 Software      |
| Holiday Pack Vol 11*        | Disc 1 Software      |
| Bloggers Social Media Pack  | Disc 1 Software      |
| Content Pack Essential      | Disc 2 Extra Content |
| Travel Pack v6*             | Disc 2 Extra Content |
| Morisawa Japanese Font Pack | Disc 2 Extra Content |

**Note:** click the **Details** button next to the item in the install wizard to view a detailed description about what each extra content pack includes. \* only available with PowerDirector Ultimate.

To install the extra content and make it available in PowerDirector, do this:

1. Find the disc that contains the extra content you want to install (see the above table) out of the disc envelope, and then insert it into your disc drive.
2. Click the **Install** button beside the extra content item that you want to install to continue. Note that you only need to install the extra content that you want.
3. Follow the steps in the installation wizard as you did before to install the content pack. Once installed, click **Finish** and then return to the first installation window to install the next extra content item, if required.

**Note:** you must first install PowerDirector before installing any of the extra content. You don't need to input a product or activation key for any of the extra content.

# Launching PowerDirector

Once CyberLink PowerDirector is installed, double-click on the desktop shortcut (or click Launch PowerDirector at the end of the installation wizard) to start the program.

**Note:** the first time you launch the program, you are asked to enter the product key. It can be found on one of the PowerDirector disc envelopes, or on a sheet that was included in the box.

## CyberLink Cloud

With your purchase of PowerDirector, you get a free subscription to the **CyberLink Cloud** service for one year, which includes free cloud storage space. CyberLink Cloud makes your media and projects accessible from any device running PowerDirector Mobile, and allows you to back up your projects, templates, and program preferences, which can be downloaded back to your computer.

You can redeem your free one year subscription the first time you launch PowerDirector or PhotoDirector by going to the **CyberLink Cloud** tab in Preferences and then clicking the **Redeem CyberLink Cloud Service** link. Follow the instructions on the web site to redeem your subscription.

## Getting You Started in PowerDirector 2024

Follow these steps to start editing your videos in CyberLink PowerDirector.

### Importing Media into PowerDirector

The first step in creating your production is to import your project's media into PowerDirector. You can import media by:

- **Importing media files:** if you already have video, audio, and image files on your computer's hard drive, you can import the files directly into the media library. This is done by clicking on the **Import** button in **Media**.
- **Capturing media:** you can capture media from a variety of sources, including a video camcorder, webcam, microphone, and more. Just select **Capture** from the **File** menu to enter the Capture module.
- **Downloading media:** you can download templates and effects from DirectorZone and your backed up media from CyberLink Cloud. Just click the **Import** button in **Media** to start downloading content into the media library.

### Editing Your Media

Once you have your media in the media library, you can begin putting your video production together. The following outlines some of the procedures and features you can use to create your production.

#### Video Intro and Outro Templates

In **Templates** you can start your video project off with video intros shared by our community of creatives on DirectorZone. Video intro templates can be added directly to the timeline, or first customized in the Video Intro Designer. Use video outro templates, which can be customized in the Video Outro Designer, to create the perfect ending for your video.

## Arranging Media in Your Production

To insert videos, images, and audio into the workspace timeline, click the **Media** button and then manually drag and drop media clips from the library, to a desired position on a track to add it to the timeline.

Continue this process until you create your production. You add the media clips in the order that tells the story you want to tell.

## Stylish Effects and Templates

Use the hundreds of professional quality built-in effects and templates available in **Titles, Transitions, Effects, and Overlays** to add creativity and flair to your production. Among the effects are the dozens of specially made body effects for your videos. You can also apply style effects on just the objects (people, pets, etc.) that are detected in video clips.

## Use the Edit, Color Adjustment, and Animation Tools

Select a media clip on the timeline and then click **Edit** to access a number of tools you can use to edit your media (Trim, Chroma Key, Motion Tracker, Video Speed Designer, Action Camera Center, Speech to Text\*, Audio Editor, and much more). Here you can also make color fixes and enhancements on your media (lighting adjustments, color enhancement, color match, split toning, and more), and add in, out, or looped animation on video and image clips.

**Note:** \* only available with PowerDirector Ultimate.

## Design Studio

Use PowerDirector's Design Studio to customize the effects and templates in your projects, or to help with your video editing. The PiP, Title, Mask, Transition, Particle, and View Designer let you use precise keyframe controls to create your own unique effects and videos. The Multi Cam, Theme, and the Video Collage Designer let you create professional looking edits of your videos, quickly. You can also use the Shape Designer\* to create custom callouts and annotations for your videos, or edit sketch animations in the Sketch Designer\* to create perfect graphic objects for tutorials and other videos.

**Note:** \* only available with PowerDirector Ultimate.

You can access some of the designers from the **Tools** menu, or just place a media clip or effect template in your production's timeline, select it, and then click the **Edit** button above the timeline to find the specific designer you want to use. Click the **Advanced** button when editing media, overlays, or title effects to open the PiP or Title Designer.

## Outputting Your Video Production

Once you are done editing your video production, you can output it by creating a video file on your computer or burning it to a disc.

## Exporting a Video File

Click the **Export** button and then on the **Export Project** tab to output your production as a video file, or upload it directly to YouTube or another social media web site. You can create video files with up to 4K Ultra HD quality, in the H.264 AVC, H.265 HEVC, XAVC S, and many other formats.

## Burning Production to a Disc

If you want to burn your production to a disc with disc menus you customize in another Design Tool, the Menu Designer, click the **Export** button and then select the **Create Disc** tab. You can burn Blu-ray Discs with Full HD 50p/60p video profiles, save productions as created DVD and Blu-ray disc ISO images, and more.

## Resources

The following are some helpful resources that are available if ever you need them.

- **Learning Center:** if you need help with a feature, or you want to learn more about what PowerDirector has to offer, just go to CyberLink's Learning Center for video tutorials and much more:  
<https://www.cyberlink.com/learning>
- **Help File:** if you need assistance with a specific feature, click the **?** icon at the top of the program window, and then select **PowerDirector Help** (or press the F1 key on your keyboard) to open the help file.
- **Search Knowledge Base:** search the product knowledge base, which includes frequently asked questions about the program and more:  
<https://www.cyberlink.com/cs-resource>
- **User Forum:** search for answers or post a topic on our user forum, where there are many users with hundreds of hours of editing experience using PowerDirector willing to help you:  
<https://forum.cyberlink.com/forum/forums/list/ENU.page>

**Note:** CyberLink's user community forum is only available in English, German, and Japanese.

- **Customer Support:** solutions to your problems are available 24 hours a day at no cost on the CyberLink Customer Support page:  
<https://www.cyberlink.com/support/index.html>